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**The Newsletter of the Friends of
Telford Town Park**

Summer 2011



Photo prizes up for grabs

Keen amateur photographers are being urged to enter our photo competition. Photographic prizes are up for grabs and twelve of the best pictures will hopefully be featured in a calendar to be published later this year, the proceeds of which will help further our work.

The theme is "Our Beautiful Park, so pictures should capture the park's heritage, landscapes or wildlife, but should not include people. They must have been taken between 1st October 2010 and September 30th this year.

We want to show that the town park is a fantastic place to explore, right in the heart of Telford. It doesn't matter what sort of camera you have, you can still take a great photo and enter our competition. Summer is a wonderful time for exploring the park, but we're also looking for entries taken throughout the seasons. So why not put on your walking boots and get snapping, or look through some of your winter shots.



Prizes include a camera donated by Ricoh and a printer donated by Epson plus vouchers. Entries should be submitted as hard copy prints (minimum size 15 x 10 cm or 6 x 4 in; maximum 25 x 20 cm or 10 x 8 in). Please post entries to FOTTP Photo Competition, Telford Town Park, Civic Offices, 2nd Floor, Walker House, TELFORD TF3 4HD. The closing date is 30th September, so don't delay!

Full details of the competition and complete rules can be found at and downloaded from our website: www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

A Remarkable Year

Our AGM in April gave us the opportunity to look back on what has been a remarkable year for the Friends and for the town park. The biggest news came in October with the announcement that Telford & Wrekin Council had been successful in gaining a lottery bid for over £2 million under the Parks for People project. The money will transform the park, making it easier for visitors to explore the historical and natural heritage and create new opportunities for local people to take part in wildlife, horticultural and educational projects. On top of that we have learned that the park will be getting a brand new visitor centre, built to the highest standards of environmental sustainability, and seen the dedication of the new Memorial.

Another successful campaign by the friends, and the culmination of years of painstaking work, was the awarding of Fields In Trust status to the Arena. This means it will remain protected from development and remained as an open space for the enjoyment of the people of Telford and beyond. It will be formally renamed the Queen Elizabeth Arena to coincide with the Diamond Jubilee next year.



But it hasn't just been big projects that we have been involved in. An award of £2760 from the big lottery enabled us to carry out work at The Crannog near Stirchley Grange. We reinstated the bridge to the island and improved the pathway. Further work by Telford Green Gym and Friends members saw construction of a living willow hide. We have also been busy installing bat and bird boxes and planting

hedges in several parts of the park and taking part in surveys on water quality, air quality and hedgerows under the OPAL project initiative.

Events we have organised included the Santa Fun Run, which gets bigger every year (see page 4 for details of this year's event.) We've also been out and about at events around the borough, including Madeley On the Map Day, Dawley Day, Hollinswood & Randlay Fun Day and Culture Fest.

In short, the group continues to grow – we now have 24 members – but we remain true to our original aim: to make Telford Town Park one of the the best in the country. So we thank everyone who has helped us in our work and say - let's make 2011-2012 our best year yet!

Bat Walks and Heritage Walk

Our last bat walk, conducted by John Morgan of the Shropshire Bat Group was a fantastic success and was fully booked. You may have seen our advance publicity in the Shropshire Star. Bats are some of our most mysterious and elusive wild creatures, so take the opportunity of having an expert on hand to seek out and identify them. Places are still available for the next walk on Tuesday 9th August at 8:45, but please book as soon as possible.



We are also running another of our popular Heritage Walks in conjunction with NHS Telford & Wrekin Community Health Services and Walkabout Wrekin. This takes place on Saturday 27th August at 12 noon. Again, please book in advance as soon as possible. **Both events start and finish at the Norman Chapel. Please book by phoning 01952 382340 in office hours.**

Santa Fun Run

It may be the height of summer, but we're already thinking ahead to Sunday 11th December - the date of our 5th annual Santa Fun Run. As usual, we will be supporting the RNIB and Guide Dogs for the Blind. The event will start at the Arena and be approximately two miles long. Watch out for more on this event, which promises to be a fun day for all involved.

Friends of Telford Town Park

We are a group of volunteers committed to protecting the Town Park, its natural and industrial heritage and promoting its enjoyment. All are welcome to join and membership is free. As from August we will be meeting on the second Wednesday of every other month at 6pm in Committee Room 2 of the Borough Council civic offices.

For more information call 01952 382340
Or visit our website www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org